

The Launch Decision

One business. Four perspectives. One decision.

A half-day cross-functional collaboration experience



**What happens when smart people,
working toward the same business
outcome, don't have the same picture?**



How today works

01

You'll experience it before we name it.

We start with a decision, not a model.

02

There's no right answer to find.

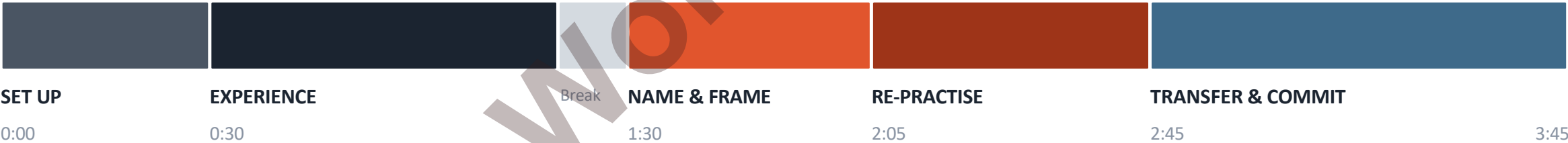
We're interested in how decisions get made.

03

This is a practice space.

Nothing here is assessed.

THE SHAPE OF THE DAY



Think of a recent decision that needed more than one function.



What did your function see clearly?



What did you only learn later, and from whom?

Trios · mixed functions 1 min think · 7 min talk · 2 min share

NexaTech is launching

NexaFlow

A new technology solution designed to help large organisations manage and automate high-volume internal processes.

Launch is scheduled six weeks from now

It is strategically important

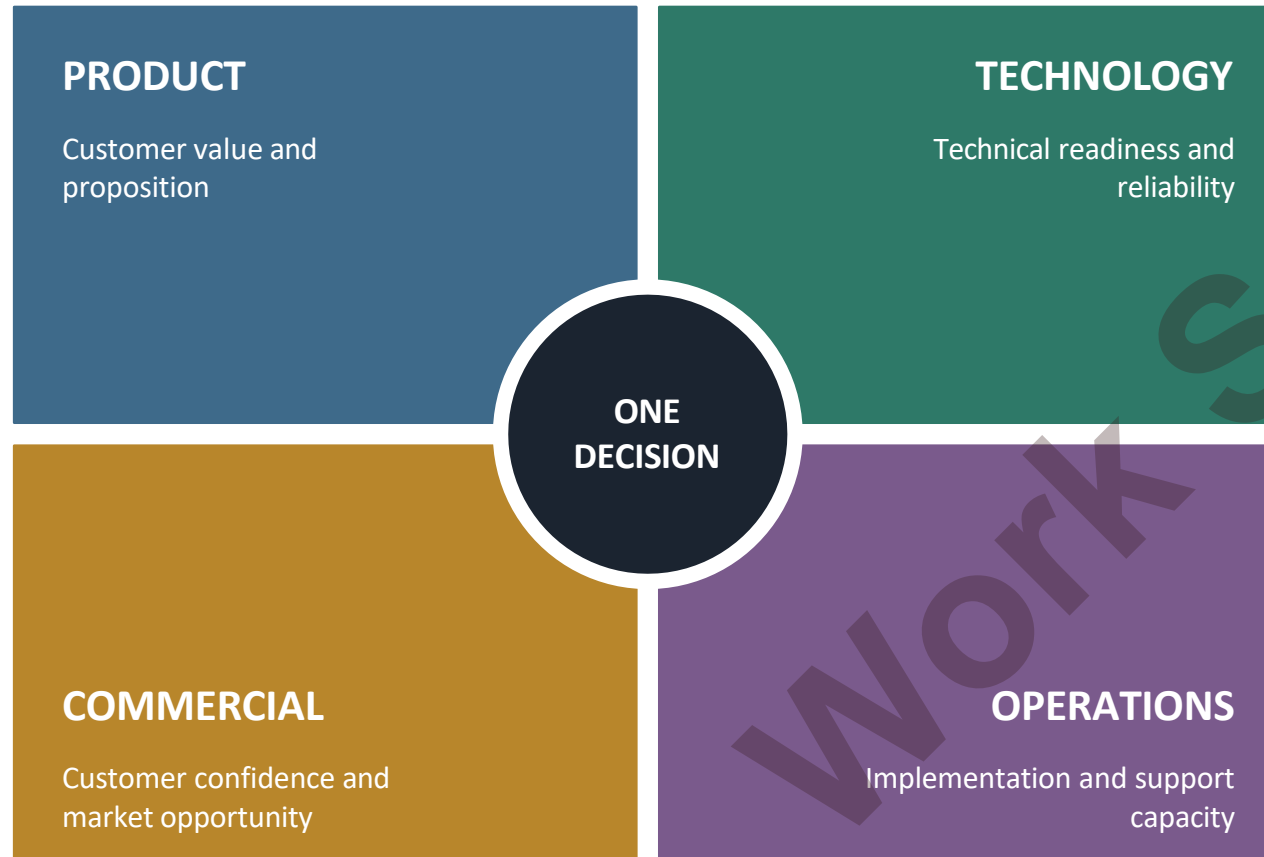
Significant investment has already been made

Early customer interest is strong

The project is officially considered on track

However, different functions see different readiness signals.

Four perspectives



Each function has part of the picture.

For this simulation, you are temporarily representing a functional perspective. You are not expected to behave according to your actual job function.

One collective recommendation

Launch as planned

Phase the launch

Reduce initial scope

Delay the launch

EXPLAIN

What are we protecting?

What are we willing to compromise?

What is the biggest risk we are accepting?

What needs to happen next?

There is no predetermined correct answer.

Build your function's view

In your function area

01

What is our function responsible for?

02

What are we protecting?

03

What concerns us most?

04

What information do we have that others may need?

05

What do we need to understand from the other functions?

06

What would we initially recommend?

Four functions. One room. One recommendation.

20
MINUTES

- 01 Bring your perspective into the decision room.
- 02 Agree one recommendation the organisation can own.
- 03 Complete the Round 1 Decision Sheet.

Launch as planned
Phase the launch
Reduce initial scope
Delay the launch

Before you commit

- ☐ Have we heard all four perspectives?
- ☐ Have we surfaced the most important risks?
- ☐ Are we making assumptions we have not checked?
- ☐ Can all four functions explain why this is a decision the organisation can own?

What happened?

What happened in the first few minutes?

What did your function do first?

What information did you have?

What were you missing?

When did you approach another function?

What changed your view?

How did we work?

What made you share information?

What made you hold information back?

Did you ask before proposing?

Where did assumptions appear?

Did anyone challenge an assumption?

Which risks only became visible later?

Where did it become “our function versus theirs”?

What was the impact?

What happened to the quality or speed of the decision?

What happened when information arrived late?

Where did assumptions replace conversations?

Which dependencies became visible only when another function spoke?



**If you could replay those 20 minutes,
what would you do differently?**



Break

10 minutes

Work Sample



Different perspectives are not the problem.
A fragmented picture is.



Four observable behaviours that strengthen cross-functional collaboration and working trust



Alignment does not require agreement on everything. It requires enough shared understanding to make and own a decision together.

Looking back at Round 1

In your function area · capture on your flipchart

SHARE

One piece of information we should have made visible earlier.

SEEK

One question we should have asked another function.

SURFACE

One risk or disagreement that needed to be made more explicit.

ALIGN

One condition we would need to support the collective decision.

A strategically important customer asks whether NexaFlow can be made available two weeks earlier because its own transformation programme has moved forward.

- Technology confirms that the high-volume performance issue can be managed through a controlled rollout.
- A full-scale launch still carries elevated technical risk.
- Operations can support a limited initial rollout but not projected full volume immediately.
- The customer is strategically important.

Revisit the decision.

You may keep or change your recommendation.

THIS TIME, USE

SHARE

SEEK

SURFACE

ALIGN

20
MINUTES

ANSWER

Recommendation

What are we protecting?

What are we compromising?

What risk are we accepting?

What needs to happen next?



What was different this time?

SHARE

What did you make visible earlier?

SEEK

What questions changed your understanding?

SURFACE

What risk or disagreement became easier to discuss?

ALIGN

What changed when you focused on the organisational decision rather than the position of your function?

Did using the framework guarantee agreement?

One real cross-functional situation

that is currently costing

Time

Trust

Performance

- 01 What is happening?
- 02 What am I assuming?
- 03 What information is not being surfaced?
- 04 Which behaviour is most needed?
- 05 What conversation needs to happen?
- 06 What action can I take?

Don't solve it.

Help them see it.

- 01 What might you be assuming?
- 02 What information might you be missing?
- 03 What needs to be surfaced?
- 04 What would alignment look like?

2 min · describe

4 min · questions only

1 min · one thing I see differently

* swap

In my next cross-functional interaction, I will...

SPECIFIC AND OBSERVABLE

Ask two questions before proposing a solution.

Surface a delivery risk earlier.

Share a constraint before it becomes a blocker.

End a cross-functional discussion by confirming the shared outcome and next action.

TOO VAGUE TO ACT ON

~~Collaborate better~~

~~Communicate more~~

~~Build trust~~

The test: could someone watching you notice it happen?

Cross-functional collaboration doesn't require everyone to think the same way. It requires us to make enough of the picture visible for different perspectives to become a better collective decision.

**The goal isn't fewer perspectives.
It's a better shared picture.**

